**25900350**

**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**
**MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025**
**Third SEMESTER**
**Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEECOA00 - FUNDAMENTALS OF RURAL MANAGEMENT**
**(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)**

**Duration: 2 Hours** **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse (An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation (Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

**Part A**

One or Two Sentences, answer any 10 questions, each question carries 2 marks

1. **Define inclusive growth and explain how it contributes to national development.**
   Inclusive growth refers to economic growth that creates opportunities for all sections of society and ensures equitable access to benefits. It contributes to national development by reducing poverty, inequality, and social exclusion.
2. **How does motivation help in development projects?**
   Motivation enhances participation and commitment in development projects, ensuring that beneficiaries and workers stay focused on achieving project goals.
3. **What is the main goal of livelihood interventions?**
   The main goal of livelihood interventions is to create sustainable income opportunities that improve living standards and reduce vulnerability among marginalized groups.
4. **Why are Self-Help Groups (SHGs) important for rural women?**
   Self-Help Groups (SHGs) empower rural women by promoting savings, credit access, collective decision-making, and social confidence.
5. **Define the Human Development Index (HDI).**
   The Human Development Index (HDI) measures a country's average achievement in health, education, and income, reflecting overall human well-being.
6. **How is livelihood promotion different from employment generation?**
   Livelihood promotion focuses on building long-term income-generating capacities, while employment generation provides short-term job opportunities.
7. **What is centralized planning in rural development?**
   Centralized planning involves decision-making and resource allocation by higher authorities, typically the central government, for achieving national development goals.
8. **What is sustainable agriculture?**
   Sustainable agriculture uses eco-friendly practices to maintain soil fertility and productivity while conserving natural resources, ensuring long-term rural prosperity.
9. **What is outcome-based planning?**
   Outcome-based planning emphasizes measurable results and impacts rather than inputs or activities, ensuring accountability and effectiveness in development programs.
10. **How does organising help in rural management?**

Organising helps coordinate resources, roles, and responsibilities efficiently, leading to better implementation of rural management initiatives.

**11. What is the significance of electricity in promoting agro-based rural industries?**

Electricity supports agro-based rural industries by powering irrigation, processing units, and storage facilities, thereby enhancing productivity and income.

**12. Why is corrective action important in project implementation?**

Corrective action is essential in project implementation to address deviations, improve performance, and ensure that objectives are met effectively.

**(2 x 10 =20)**

## Part B

**Short Answer questions, answer any 10 questions, each question carries 5 marks**

**13. Explain the role of resource access in achieving livelihood resilience.**

Access to productive resources such as land, water, credit, and technology enables rural communities to diversify their livelihoods and withstand economic or environmental shocks. Secure access reduces vulnerability, enhances adaptive capacity, and supports sustainable income generation—key elements of livelihood resilience.

**14. Critically assess the challenges and opportunities of participatory planning in India.**

Participatory planning promotes grassroots democracy and local ownership in development. However, it faces challenges such as bureaucratic rigidity, unequal power relations, and limited awareness at the community level. Despite these issues, it offers opportunities for inclusive decision-making, transparency, and effective local resource utilization.

**15. How do people-centered and holistic approaches complement each other?**

People-centered approaches focus on empowering individuals and communities, while holistic approaches integrate economic, social, and environmental dimensions. Together, they ensure that development addresses both human needs and systemic sustainability, creating more balanced and long-lasting outcomes.

**16. How does rural management differ from rural development in practical application?**

Rural management emphasizes the administrative and operational aspects of implementing programs, while rural development focuses on achieving broader socio-economic transformation. In practice, management ensures efficiency and coordination, whereas development measures long-term impact on livelihoods and well-being.

**17. Evaluate the interrelationship of local leadership, volunteers, and extension workers in community development.**

Local leaders provide vision and mobilization, volunteers ensure grassroots participation, and extension workers deliver technical expertise. Their collaboration fosters trust, ensures resource optimization, and strengthens institutional linkages, which are essential for sustainable community development outcomes.

**18. Why is Natural Capital considered the foundation of rural livelihoods?**

Natural capital—comprising land, water, forests, and biodiversity—forms the basis of rural production and survival. Dependence on these resources for agriculture, grazing, and non-farm activities makes their conservation vital for maintaining income security and ecological balance.

**19. How do cooperative credit societies promote financial inclusion in villages?**

Cooperative credit societies provide affordable loans, encourage savings, and reduce dependence

on informal moneylenders. By pooling local resources and reinvesting profits within the community, they foster entrepreneurship, self-reliance, and inclusive financial growth in rural areas.

20. **Critically assess the challenges Panchayats face in implementing rural schemes effectively.** Panchayats often struggle with inadequate funds, limited administrative capacity, and political interference. While decentralization has empowered local governance, the absence of skilled personnel and delayed fund release often hinder effective implementation of rural schemes.
21. **How did liberalisation in the 1990s reshape rural poverty alleviation strategies?** Post-liberalisation, rural development policies shifted from state-led interventions to market-oriented and participatory models. Greater emphasis was placed on self-employment, microfinance, and skill-based programs like SGSY and MGNREGA, promoting empowerment and inclusion alongside growth.
22. **How can resource management, inclusiveness, gender equity, and sustainability be integrated into a single rural development model?**
    A holistic rural model can integrate these principles by ensuring equitable access to resources, empowering women through SHGs, promoting participatory governance, and adopting sustainable technologies. Such integration ensures long-term economic, social, and environmental balance.
23. **Explain how the agricultural component of IRDP supported poverty reduction in rural India.** The Integrated Rural Development Programme (IRDP) provided assets, credit, and training to rural households, enabling them to engage in productive agricultural activities. This improved income generation, self-employment, and asset ownership, directly reducing rural poverty.
24. **Explain how the Strategy for New India @75 integrates agriculture as a core driver of development.**
    The Strategy for New India @75 emphasizes doubling farmers' income through modernization, market reforms, irrigation efficiency, and allied sector growth. It positions agriculture as a key contributor to employment, food security, and rural industrialization.
25. **How can income and employment indicators be used to assess rural well-being?**
    Income and employment levels reflect the economic health and inclusiveness of rural communities. Rising wages, diversified occupations, and stable job opportunities indicate improved living standards, reduced poverty, and progress toward sustainable rural well-being.
26. **In what ways does inclusive growth influence rural economic transformation?**
    Inclusive growth ensures equitable access to resources, education, and markets, allowing all sections to benefit from development. It transforms rural economies by generating productive employment, reducing inequality, and fostering social cohesion.
27. **Compare and evaluate farmer producer groups (FPOs) with cooperatives as institutional models.**
    Both FPOs and cooperatives promote collective action, but FPOs are market-oriented entities providing better price realization and input linkages. Cooperatives, though socially driven, often face bureaucratic hurdles. FPOs thus offer a more flexible and entrepreneurial approach to rural institution-building.

**(5 x 10 = 50)**